

Unit 1: The Afternoon Everything Happened at Once

English for Daily Life • Level: B1 • Tracks: [CORE] Warm-Up + Parts 1–6 • [PLUS] Parts 7–10

UNIT 1

The Afternoon Everything Happened at Once

THE GRAMMAR

The past continuous and the past simple — while and when

IN THIS UNIT



By the end of this unit you can

- ☐ I can say what I was doing when something interrupted me.
- ☐ I can use while and when to join a long action and a short one.
- ☐ I can tell the story of an afternoon in 90-110 words.

Core track: Warm Up and Parts 1 to 6

Plus track: Parts 7 to 10, optional

Warm Up

[CORE] Core track • in-class starter

Warm-up: Words for a Busy Afternoon

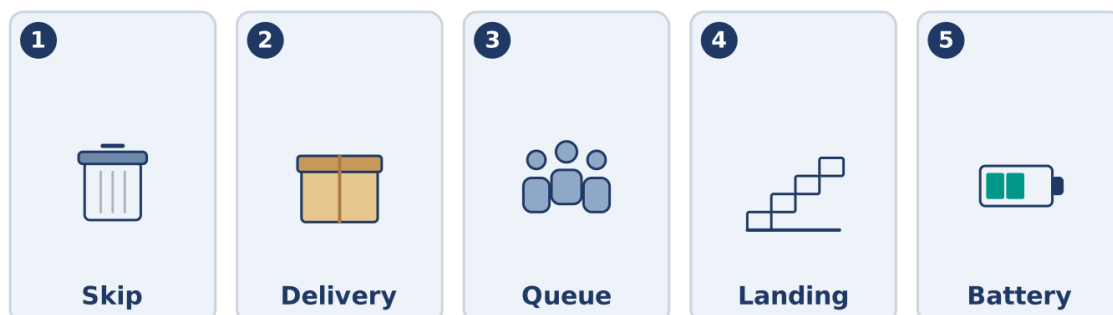


Figure 1.2 • The five warm-up words, and the thing each one means.

Match the words with their meanings. One meaning is not needed. Write the letter.

Column A

1.	Skip	_____
2.	Delivery	_____
3.	Queue	_____
4.	Landing	_____
5.	Battery	_____

Column B

a)	the flat space at the top of a flight of stairs
b)	a large open metal container that is left in the street for rubbish
c)	the part inside a phone that holds the power
d)	the small room where a shop keeps what it has not sold
e)	a line of people waiting for their turn
f)	goods brought to an address at an arranged time

Warm-up: Saying What Was Going On



Figure 1.3 · The word bank for this task, in the order it is printed.

Complete the sentences using the words in the word bank.

Word bank: connection | landing | battery | car park

1. Tomas was halfway across town when his phone died, because the _____ was low from the start.
2. Yuki lost her _____ in the middle of a video call, and the others carried on without her for four minutes.
3. Two groups of children were playing in the _____ behind the building at some point that afternoon.
4. Mr Okonkwo was standing on the half _____ with the street door propped open below him.

Warm-up: Six People, One Saturday

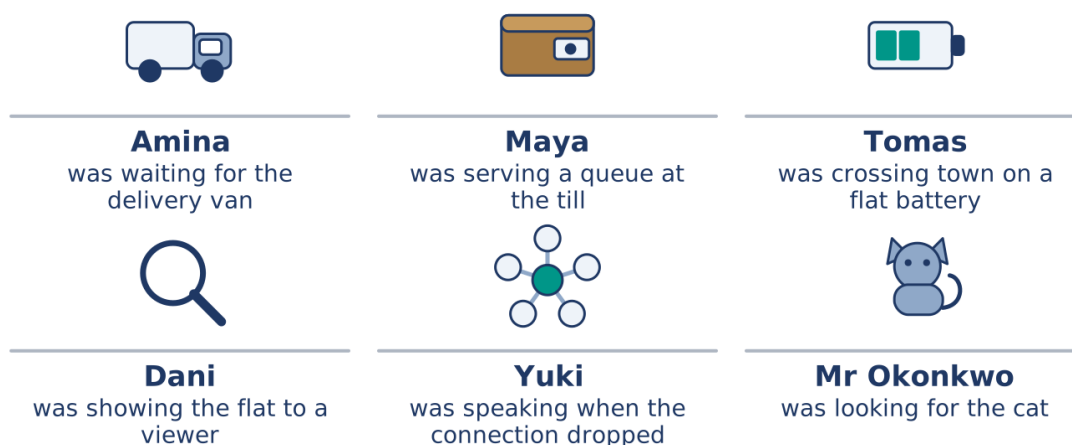


Figure 1.4 · Number 14 on Saturday afternoon, and what each of them was doing.

Read the text and choose the correct answer.

On the first Saturday in November, six people who live at or near 14 Alder Street had an afternoon that none of them wanted. Amina was waiting for a delivery that never arrived. A lorry left a skip outside the wrong house, and her van could not get past it. Maya was serving a queue of eleven people in the bookshop when the card reader stopped working. Tomas was crossing town to cover a

shift, and his phone went flat somewhere near the ring road. Dani was showing the empty flat to somebody while the letting agent was emailing to say that another viewer took it. Yuki was speaking in a video call when the connection dropped. Mr Okonkwo spent three hours looking for a cat that walked out through a door propped open for the skip. None of them knew about any of the others until the evening.

1. What was Maya doing when the card reader stopped working?

- A) Serving a queue in the bookshop
- B) Waiting for a delivery
- C) Showing somebody an empty flat
- D) Crossing town to cover a shift

2. Why did Amina's delivery never arrive?

- A) The driver had the wrong address for it
 - B) A skip was blocking the way for the van
 - C) The shop was closed when it came
 - D) The depot sent it out a day late
- Part 1 • Vocabulary and Terminology**

[CORE] Core track • pre-class input

Part 1: Words for a Street That Is Not Working

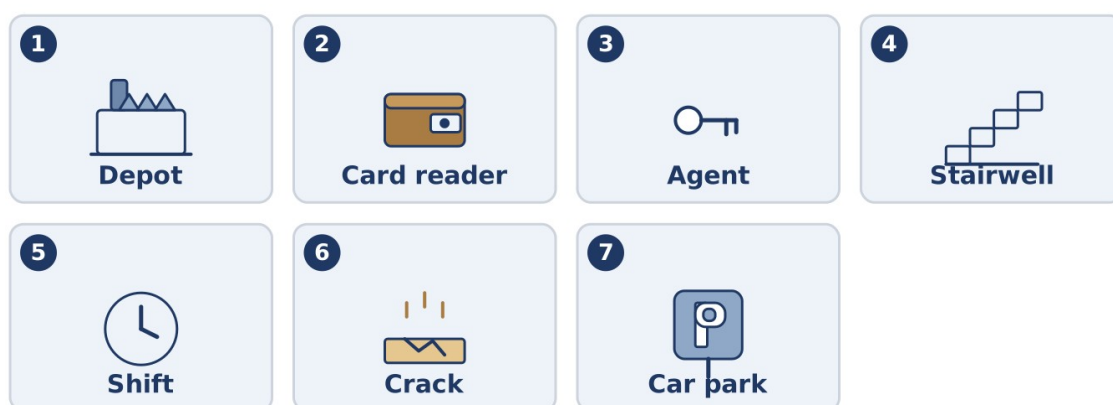


Figure 1.5 • The seven words of Column A, and what each one is.

Match the words with their meanings. One meaning is not needed. (0. is done for you.)

Gloss: *depot* — the building a delivery company keeps its vans in • *agent* — somebody paid to let a property for its owner • *card reader* — the machine in a shop that takes a payment from a card • *stairwell* — the space a staircase runs up, from the street door to the top • *crack* — a thin line where something has broken but not come apart; glass that has cracked is still in one piece

0. Pavement → the paved path at the side of a road, for people on foot.

Column A

1.	Depot	—
----	-------	---

2.	Card reader	_____
3.	Agent	_____
4.	Stairwell	_____
5.	Shift	_____
6.	Crack	_____
7.	Car park	_____

Column B

a)	a thin line where something has broken but not come apart
b)	the space a staircase runs up, from the door to the top floor
c)	the hours somebody works, sometimes beginning in the evening
d)	the open ground beside a building where cars are left
e)	the building where a company keeps its vans and its goods
f)	somebody paid to let or sell a property for its owner
g)	the machine in a shop that takes a payment from a card
h)	the paper slip a shop writes out when a machine has failed

Part 1: Pronunciation

1 I was **crossing** town when the battery went flat

2 She was **serving** a queue when the reader stopped

3 The cat went out while the door was **propped** open

4 We were **standing** on the steps for twenty minutes

Figure 1.6 · Where the stress falls in four lines of this unit.



Audio Track 1.1

Listen and repeat. In each line, the beat falls on the words in bold.

I was **CROSS**ing **TOWN** when the **BATT**ery went **FLAT**.

She was **SERVing** a **QUEUE** when the **READer** stopped.

The **CAT** went **OUT** while the **DOOR** was **PROPPED** open.

We were **STANDING** on the **STEPS** for **TWENTy** **MINutes**.

was and were almost never carry the beat. In ordinary speech was becomes /wəz/ and were becomes /wə/. At speed a learner listening for them hears nothing at all, so listen for the *-ing* instead. The *-ing* tells you the sentence is about something in the middle of happening, and it is the part that is easy to hear.

Part 1: What Kind of Word Is It?



Figure 1.7 · Things you can touch, and things you cannot.

Write **yes** or **no** beside each word. (0. is done for you.)

0. skip → something you can touch.

The word	Can you touch it?
skip	yes
battery	—
connection	—
delivery	—
pavement	—
queue	—
shift	—
stairwell	—

The word	Can you touch it?
capacity	_____

Words: battery | connection | delivery | pavement | queue | shift | stairwell | capacity

Part 1: Where Does Each One Happen?

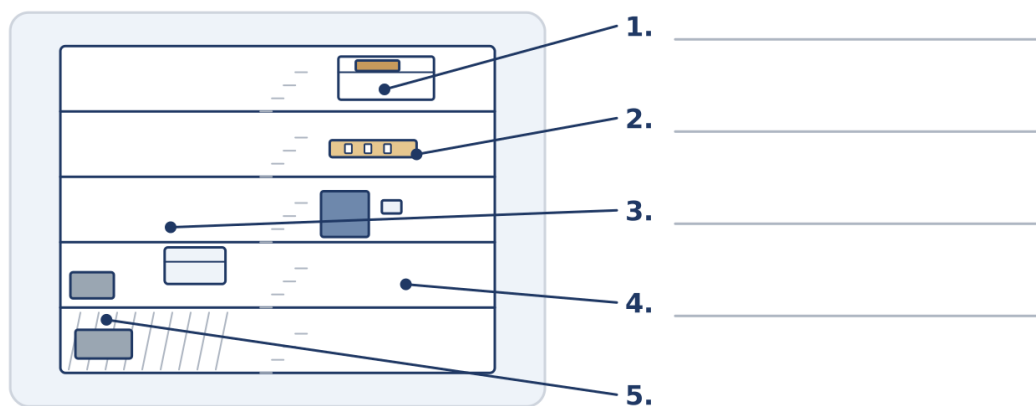


Figure 1.8 · The street in section — write the correct word beside each place.

Match each thing with the place you would find it, working from the street inwards. One place is not needed. Write the letter.

Column A

1.	The skip	_____
2.	The card reader	_____
3.	The cracked window	_____
4.	The propped door	_____
5.	The two groups of children	_____

Column B

a)	on the half landing, four steps above the street door
b)	at the foot of the stairwell, with a brick holding it back
c)	on the pavement outside number 14, where nobody ordered it
d)	in the car park behind the building, out of sight of the flats

e)	beside the till at Hadley Books, two streets away
f)	in the depot on the far side of the ring road

Part 1: Streets and Interruptions — Multiple Choice

Choose the correct answer.

1. The building where a delivery company keeps its vans is the...

- ☐ A) landing
- ☐ B) stairwell
- ☐ C) pavement
- ☐ D) depot

2. The hours somebody works, sometimes beginning in the evening, is a...

- ☐ A) queue
- ☐ B) slot
- ☐ C) shift
- ☐ D) crack

3. Somebody paid to let a flat for its owner is an...

- ☐ A) agent
- ☐ B) operator
- ☐ C) resident
- ☐ D) engineer

Part 1: Vocabulary Fill-in



Figure 1.9 • The four words of the bank, in the order the task gives them.

Complete the sentences using the words in the word bank.

Word bank: stairwell | queue | card reader | cat

1. The _____ at Hadley Books stopped talking to the bank at ten past two.
2. Seven of the eleven people in the _____ had no cash on them at all, and two of them left without buying anything.

3. The _____ went down four steps, out through the propped door, and was not seen again until ten past five.
4. Sound carries in a _____, and that is why Mr Okonkwo heard the skip lorry.

Part 1: Write About an Afternoon That Did Not Go to Plan (short)

1	What you were doing	I was carrying shopping up to the flat.
2	What interrupted it	My phone rang, and the battery was low.
3	What the second thing was	The man below me left the street door open.
4	Which one cost the time	All of it took twice as long.

Figure 1.10 • The shape of your two or three sentences, with the model beside each step.

Model — read this first:

Last month I had one of those afternoons where three things went wrong together. I was carrying shopping up to the flat when my phone rang, and the battery was low. I put the box down on the half landing to answer it. While I was talking, the man below me went out and left the street door open. I came back an hour later and the box was in the car park. Nobody was at fault, and all of it took twice as long. (85 words)

Write 60–80 words about an afternoon when more than one thing went wrong. Say what you were doing when each one happened, and which of them cost you the most time. Part 2 •

Grammar — Past Continuous vs Past Simple

[CORE] Core track • pre-class input

Part 2: Notice

1	The lorry left the skip on the pavement
2	The van was arriving when the lorry left
3	Then the van arrived
4	The van was in the middle of coming down

Figure 1.11 • Lines from the notice, with the target form ringed in each.

Read the two sentences. What is the difference between them?

The lorry **left** the skip on the pavement, and then the van **arrived**.

The van **was arriving** when the lorry **left** the skip on the pavement.

In the first sentence the two events stand in a row, one after the other, so the driver of the van could still turn round at the corner. In the second they cross. The van was already in the middle of coming down the street, and the skip went down in front of it. Nothing in the vocabulary has changed, and nothing about the time has changed. What has changed is whether the action was finished or still going on, and in English that difference lives inside the verb.

Part 2: Grammar Focus Box

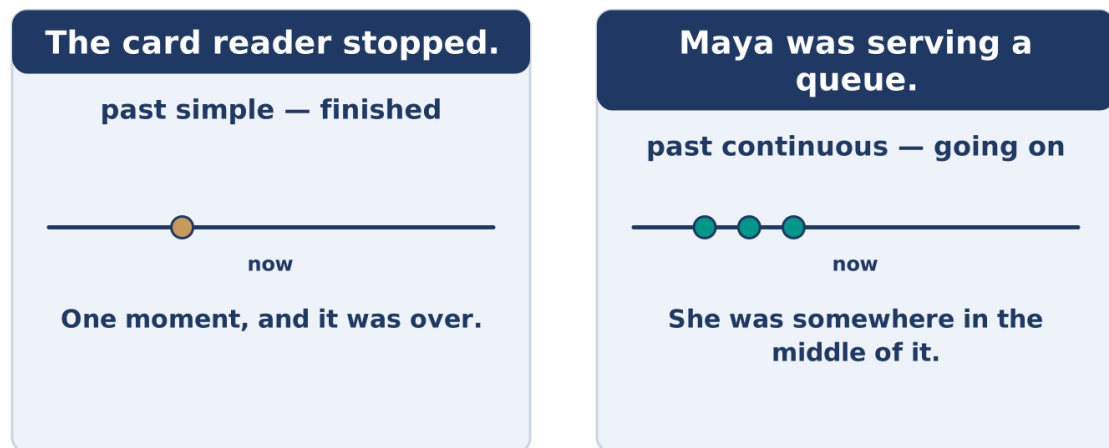


Figure 1.12 · Finished, and still going on: two pasts, two jobs.

	Form	Use	Example
past simple	verb + -ed, or irregular	the thing that happened, and finished	The card reader stopped at 2.10.
past continuous	was/were + -ing	the longer action, in the middle of happening	She was serving a queue.
when	+ past simple	introduces the short, finished action	I was crossing town when it died.
while	+ past continuous	introduces the longer background action	While I was crossing town, it died.
negative	was/were not + -ing	the background that was not happening	He was not watching the car park.

Remember: some verbs are almost never used in the continuous, however long the action lasted — *know, believe, understand, belong, own, need, want, hear, see, like, hate*. *I was knowing the answer* is not English, and the past simple is what you want instead.

Watch out! × *While the queue was waiting, the card reader were stopping.* → ✓ *...the card reader stopped.* (the thing that interrupts is past simple). × *I was understanding the problem.* → ✓ *I understood the problem.*

Part 2: Controlled Practice

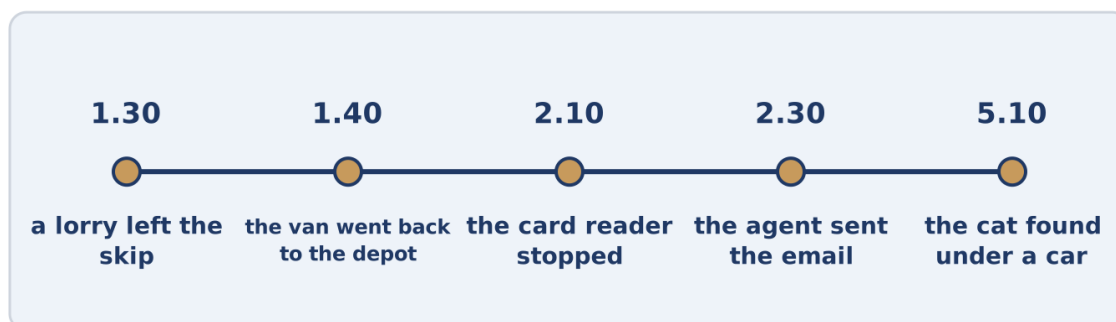


Figure 1.13 · One Saturday afternoon, from one o'clock until six.

Put the verb into the past simple or the past continuous. (0. is done for you.)

0. Dani **was showing** (show) the flat when the agent **sent** (send) the email.
1. Two groups of children _____ (play) in the car park when the window _____ (crack).
2. While Yuki _____ (speak), the connection _____ (drop) without any warning.
3. The cat _____ (go) out while nobody _____ (watch) the propped door.
4. Mr Okonkwo _____ (look) under the cars and _____ (not hear) the lorry leave.

Part 2: Interrupted or Finished?

serving a queue when the reader stopped	wrote the amount on a slip	counting the stock when the bank rang	paid in cash and went out
---	----------------------------	---------------------------------------	---------------------------

interrupted	finished
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

Figure 1.14 • The items of this task, and the bins they sort into.

Write *interrupted* or *finished* for each sentence. (0. is done for you.)

0. Maya was serving a queue when the card reader stopped. — **interrupted**

The sentence	Interrupted or finished?
Maya was serving a queue when the card reader stopped.	interrupted
She wrote the amount on a slip and gave it to him.	_____
They were counting the stock when the bank rang back.	_____
He paid in cash and went out of the bookshop.	_____
We were waiting at the till for twenty minutes.	_____

Part 2: Correct the Sentence

 While Yuki was speaking, the connection were dropping.	→	 ...the connection dropped.
 I was knowing the answer before anybody asked me.	→	 _____
 Yuki was joining the call again when she was losing it.	→	 _____
 While the others talking, nobody noticed that she left.	→	 _____

Figure 1.15 · One correction done for you, and the rest to write.

One word is wrong in each sentence. Write the sentence correctly.

1. While Yuki was speaking, the connection were dropping.
2. I was knowing the answer before anybody asked me the question.
3. Yuki was joining the call again when she was losing it a second time.
4. While the others talking, nobody noticed that she left.

Part 2: Freer Practice

Write two sentences about last Saturday afternoon — the skip on the pavement, the queue at the bookshop, or something of your own. Use *when* in one and *while* in the other.

Part 2: Grammar Review

Choose the correct answer.

1. Which sentence says that Maya finished serving the queue?

- A) Maya was serving the queue when the reader stopped
- B) Maya served the queue, and then the reader stopped
- C) While Maya was serving the queue, the reader stopped
- D) Maya was still serving the queue as the reader stopped

2. Which sentence is not possible in English?

- A) I was standing on the pavement
- B) I was waiting for the delivery
- C) I was understanding the problem
- D) I was looking for the skip

→ **Harvest:** you will meet the past continuous again in the Part 5 reading, where it does most of the work of telling the story, and in the Part 3 recordings, where you have to hear it rather than read it. **Part 3 • Listening**

[CORE] Core track • pre-class input • scripts printed inline

Part 3: Tomas and the Forty-Two

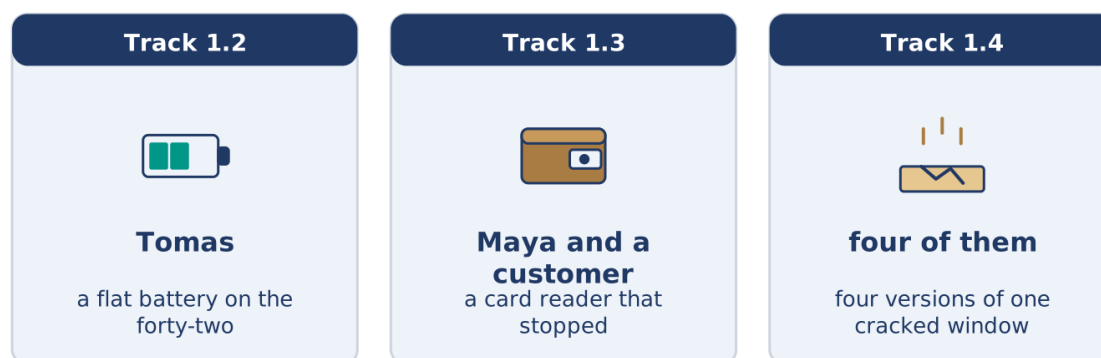


Figure 1.16 • The three listenings: who is speaking, and about what.

Audio Track 1.2

Before you listen: Tomas was crossing town to cover a shift when his phone went flat. Think about what you can still do without a telephone, and what you cannot.

Useful language: it went flat • somewhere near the ring road • I borrowed a phone • I know nobody's number

I was on the forty-two, about twenty minutes from the hospital. I was reading the handover notes on my phone when the screen went black. The battery sat at nine per cent all morning and I decided it would hold, and it did not. The problem is not the phone at all. The problem is that I needed to tell the ward I was coming. A colleague might cover it, and neither of us wanted to be the one who stayed at home. A woman two seats forward lent me hers straight away. I stood there with a stranger's phone in my hand and realised that I do not know a single number by heart. The ward's number lives in the phone that is flat, and so do all the others. In the end I rang the only number I know by heart, and that is my mother's, in another country. She looked up the hospital switchboard and rang it for me. Two other nurses were on the ward already, and I crossed the whole city to find that out.

Mark each statement True, False, or Not Given. (0. is done for you.)

0. Tomas was reading handover notes when his phone went black. — **True**
1. The battery went flat without any warning that morning.
2. Somebody on the bus lent Tomas a telephone.
3. Tomas was late for the shift because of the dead battery.

Part 3: The Queue at Hadley Books

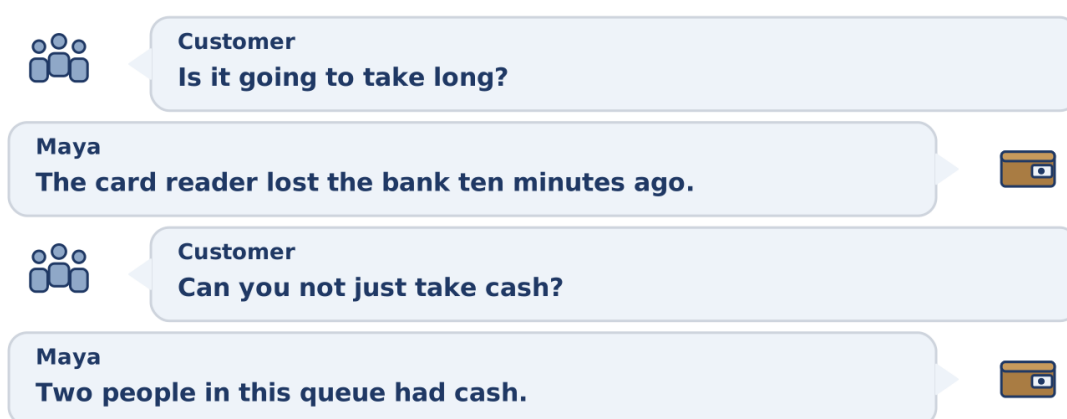


Figure 1.17 · The second listening, turn by turn.

Audio Track 1.3

Before you listen: a card reader stops working in the busiest hour of a bookshop's week. Think about what a shop can and cannot do without one.

CUSTOMER: Is it going to take long? There were eleven of us when I joined this queue.

MAYA: The card reader lost the bank about ten minutes ago. I was halfway through serving the gentleman in front of you when it went.

CUSTOMER: Can you not just take cash?

MAYA: I can, and I have. Two people in this queue had cash. The rest were as surprised as I was.

CUSTOMER: There is a paper slip, isn't there? My aunt used to work in a shop.

MAYA: There is, and I have one in the drawer. It wants the long number off the front of the card. Look at yours.

CUSTOMER: There is no number on the front of mine at all.

MAYA: That is the problem in one sentence. The backup was designed for a card that does not exist any more. I have taken four names and four telephone numbers, and those four people are trusting me to ring them tomorrow.

Answer the questions. (0. is done for you.)

0. What was Maya doing when the card reader failed? — **She was serving the man in front of the queue.**
1. How many people in the queue were able to pay in cash?
2. Why could Maya not use the paper slip for this customer?
3. What did Maya do instead for four of the customers?

Part 3: Four People, Four Versions

1  Mr Okonkwo •	• a could not see the building behind something
2  A neighbour •	• b saw two of the children while looking down
3  A second neighbour •	• c saw which of the children threw the ball
	• d was there briefly and will not say for certain

Figure 1.18 · Three on the left, four on the right, and one spare.

Audio Track 1.4

Before you listen: four people describe the same hour in the car park, and no two accounts agree about the window.

Useful language: as far as I remember · the first thing I knew · it must have been about · I did not realise until later

DANI: I was carrying a bike down and I went straight through the car park to the road. There were children at the far end. I did not look up at the back of the building once, so I am no use to anybody.

MR OKONKWO: I was out there calling the cat, and I was looking under cars. That means I was looking down. Two boys went past me on the way to the gate. I noticed the crack when I came back in, and not before.

A NEIGHBOUR: I was loading a car with four bags and a child. I had the boot open the whole time, so the back of the building was behind a lid. The window was already cracked when I shut it, because I remember the line.

A SECOND NEIGHBOUR: I was in the car park for about four minutes. I was on a call and I was not watching anything. I would not swear to any of it, and I have said so from the start.

While you listen: match each speaker with what they said. One statement is not needed. (0. is done for you.)

0. Dani → went out through the car park without looking back at the building.

Column A

1.	Mr Okonkwo	_____
2.	A neighbour	_____
3.	A second neighbour	_____

Column B

a)	could not see the building behind something they opened and left open
b)	saw two of the children at close range while looking downwards
c)	saw which of the children threw the ball, and said so at once
d)	was there only briefly and will not say anything for certain

Part 4 • Speaking

[CORE] Core track • in-class output

Part 4: What Were You Doing?

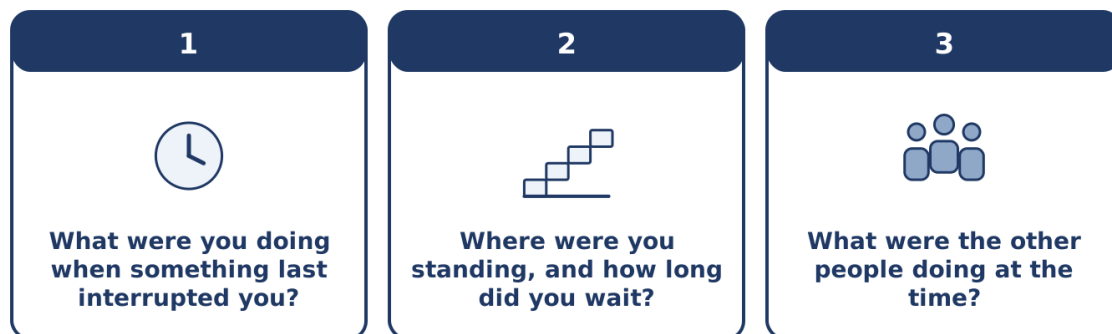


Figure 1.19 • The three questions as cards, to take one at a time.

Useful questions: What were you doing when it happened? • Where were you standing? • How long were you waiting? • What were the other people doing?

Talk to a partner. Describe a moment when something interrupted you — a flat battery, a dropped connection, a knock at the door, a delay. Say what you were doing, what interrupted it, and what you did next. Ask your partner at least three questions about theirs.

Part 4: Find the Difference (pairwork)

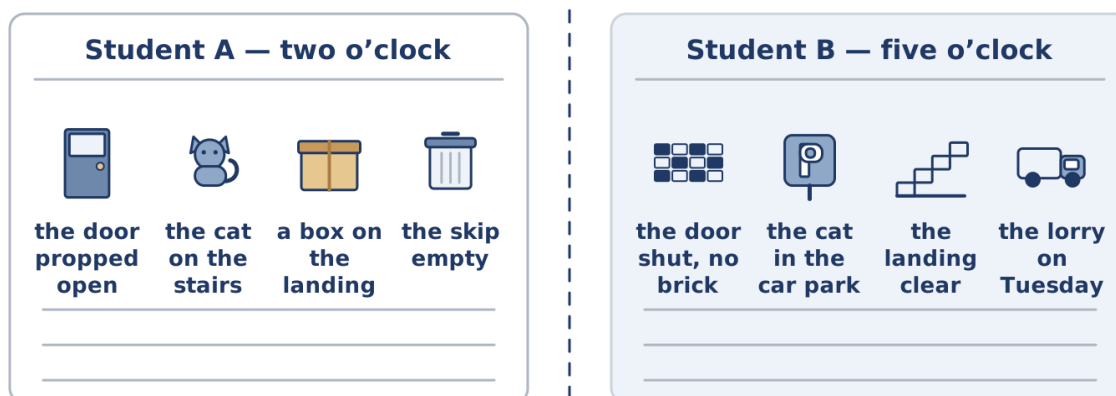


Figure 1.20 • Student A's stairwell and Student B's, with a fold between them.

Useful language: in my picture · in mine · so yours is different · neither of us has

Student A has a picture of the stairwell at two o'clock. **Student B** has a picture of the same stairwell at five. Do not look at each other's picture. Describe what people and animals were doing and find four differences. Use the past continuous for what was going on, and the past simple for anything that finished earlier.

Part 4: The Meeting About the Car Park

Card A — the car park	Card B — the fund
● say where you were in the afternoon ● say what you saw, which is nothing ● argue for a note about ball games ● say who should pay for the glass	● say what the fund holds ● say what the glass will cost ● argue against a rule nobody can enforce ● answer the other side

Figure 1.21 · Card A and Card B: what each of you has to argue.

Useful language: can I just say · that is not quite what happened · as I remember it · could we agree that

Three weeks later, the residents' meeting is in the ground-floor room. There are two questions on the paper. The first is who pays for the cracked window on the half landing. The glass there is communal, so it comes out of the building fund. The second is whether there should be a rule about ball games in the car park. The glass will cost a hundred and forty pounds, and the fund holds two hundred and ten.

Model exchange:

DANI: I was in the car park twice that afternoon and I saw nothing. A rule nobody can enforce is not a rule.

MR OKONKWO: I was out there for three hours. I am the only person who was, and I am also the only person who was looking at the ground.

AMINA: Then we have one window, two hundred and ten pounds, and nobody who saw it happen.

Work in groups of three or four. Take one role each and agree what to do about the window and the car park. Everybody must say what they were doing that afternoon before they argue for anything.

Stretch [PLUS]: argue for paying out of the fund and making no rule at all. You will have to persuade somebody who thinks the fund should never pay for damage nobody will admit to.

Part 4: Mini-Presentation

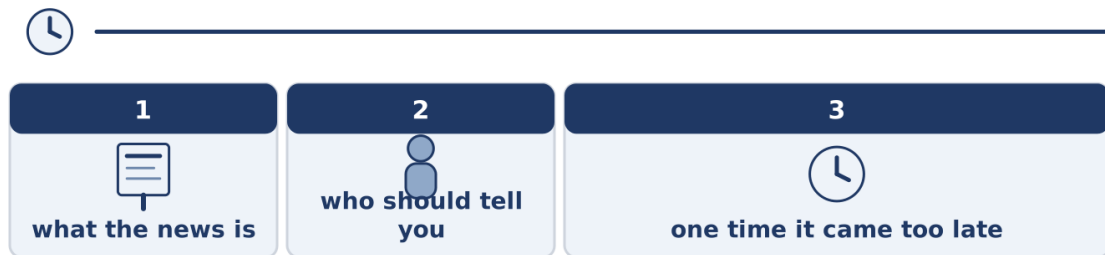


Figure 1.22 · The one-minute talk as four beats, each as wide as its share.

Speak for one minute. “The thing I would want somebody to tell me straight away.” Say what it is, who should tell you, and describe one time when the news reached you far too late — a viewing that had already been cancelled, a skip nobody ordered, a letter that named a day but not an hour. **Part 5 • Reading**

[CORE] Core track · pre-class input

Part 5: Why Two Things Always Happen at Once

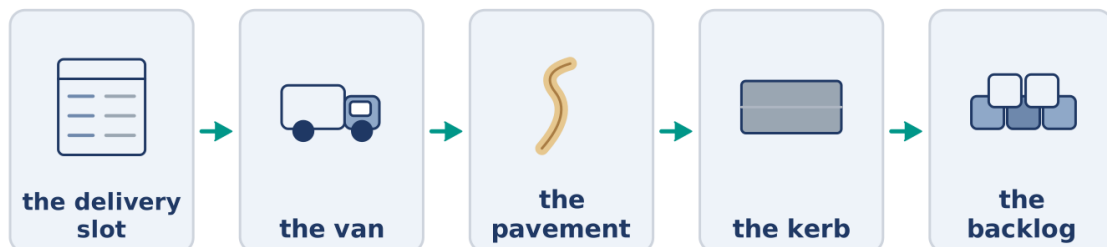


Figure 1.23 · One Saturday afternoon, hour by hour, across a single street.

Before you read: think about which hour of your week contains the largest number of other people’s arrangements.

Gloss: *overlap* — the part of two periods of time that covers the same hours · *capacity* — the largest amount a service or a place can take · *slot* — a fixed period of time booked for one job · *backlog* — work that has built up because it was not done when it should have been

A Saturday afternoon on an ordinary street looks like bad luck, and almost none of it is. Most of what goes wrong in those four hours goes wrong because other people chose the same four hours. Deliveries, viewings, repairs, shifts and family arrangements all land together, and the overlap is designed rather than accidental.

Start with the businesses and the capacity each of them works to on any given day. Saturday is the day on which the largest number of people are at home to take something in. So they sell more slots on a Saturday than on any other day, and each slot is two hours wide. A street with eleven households can easily carry nine deliveries between one and five. Two of them will want the same six metres of pavement.

Then the services behind those businesses thin out for the weekend. Banks, offices and support lines run a smaller shift at the weekend. A card reader that fails at ten past two competes for one engineer with every other reader in the city. The backlog from Friday evening has not cleared either. A fault that would take forty minutes to fix on a Tuesday takes most of the afternoon.

And at the same hour almost everybody on the street is at home. A building stands almost empty between nine and five on a Thursday. At three on a Saturday it holds all of its people, their visitors, their children and their cars. So more people see anything that happens there, and fewer of them understand it, because each one saw a different four minutes of it. That is not a failure of memory; it is what a crowded hour looks like from the inside of it.

Choose the correct answer. (0. is done for you.)

0. Which day are most people at home to take a delivery? — **Saturday.**

1. According to the text, why do delivery firms sell more slots on a Saturday?

- ☐ A) Because most people are at home to receive something
- ☐ B) Because the roads are emptier than on a weekday
- ☐ C) Because their drivers are paid less at the weekend
- ☐ D) Because the depots open earlier at the weekend

2. Why does a card reader fault take longer to fix on a Saturday?

- ☐ A) Because engineers are not allowed to work weekends
- ☐ B) Because banks close completely until the Monday
- ☐ C) Because the machines are older in weekend shops
- ☐ D) Because a smaller weekend shift is handling a backlog

3. According to the text, why is an event in a building understood by fewer people?

- ☐ A) Because nobody is willing to say what they saw
- ☐ B) Because the building is almost empty at that hour
- ☐ C) Because each person saw a different few minutes of it
- ☐ D) Because people remember weekends less clearly

Part 5: Vocabulary in Context



Figure 1.24 · The five words from the reading, drawn.

Match each word from the text with its meaning. One meaning is not needed. Write the letter.

Column A

1.	Overlap	_____
2.	Capacity	_____
3.	Slot	_____
4.	Backlog	_____
5.	Kerb	_____

Column B

a)	work that has built up because it was not done in time
b)	the edge of the pavement, where a vehicle can pull in
c)	the hours two different periods of time have in common
d)	the number of cars a car park can hold at one time
e)	a fixed period of time booked for one job
f)	the largest amount a service or a place can take

Part 5: Three Streets, Three Saturdays



Figure 1.25 · Three streets, and how much of each afternoon went to waiting.

Before you read: the same four hours look entirely different depending on which street you happen to live on.

Gloss: *peak* — the hour in which demand is at its highest · *dispute* — an argument between two sides that has not been settled · *kerb* — the edge of the pavement, where a vehicle can pull in

The street with one lane. Alder Street has a kerb on one side and a line of parked cars on the other, so one vehicle stopping stops everything behind it. The skip arrived at half past one, the peak hour for deliveries. The stock van reached the corner eleven minutes later. The driver waited for six minutes, rang the depot, and took the whole load back. Nothing on that street was broken, and one shop lost a day's trade.

The street that was rebuilt. Two miles away, Pell Road was rebuilt four years ago with a loading bay at each end. The same thing happened there on the same afternoon: a skip, a delivery, a dispute about the booking. It cost them nine minutes, because the van used the bay. Nobody on Pell Road remembers the incident, and that is the measure of it.

The street with a telephone tree. On Carrow Street, eighteen households share a list of numbers that is three years old and still accurate. When a video call drops or a connection fails in one house, somebody rings the house next door within the minute. That is how they learned that the fault was in the exchange and not in anybody's flat. They lost an afternoon too. They lost it knowing why.

Answer the questions. (0. is done for you.)

0. What time did the skip arrive on Alder Street? — **Half past one.**
1. Why did one vehicle stopping stop everything behind it on Alder Street?
2. How long did the same problem cost Pell Road, and why?
3. What did the Carrow Street households learn by ringing each other? **Part 6 • Writing**

Part 6: A Message to the Neighbours (90–110 words)

1 What you were doing	I was carrying a bike out through the car park.
2 What the damage is	The window on the half landing cracked.
3 What you are not asking	I am not trying to find out who did it.
4 What you want agreed	The fund pays for the glass this once.

Figure 1.26 • The shape of the message you are about to write.

Write a message to the other people in your building about damage that nobody saw happen. Say what you were doing at the time, and what you want everybody to agree.

Model — read this first:

Hello everybody. The window on the half landing cracked some time between three and four on Saturday. I was carrying a bike out through the car park twice that afternoon and I saw nothing, and nor did the people I have asked. I am not trying to find out who did it, because I do not think we can. What I would like is for us to agree two things at the meeting. The fund pays for the glass this once, and we put a note in the car park asking people to play at the far end. Dani, flat 3. (105 words)

Plan (fill in, then write): I was ____ when _____. The problem is _____. I am not asking for _____. What I would like is _____.

Word bank: car park | crack | fund | agree

Check before you finish: ☐ the past continuous at least twice? ☐ one clear thing you are asking for? ☐ what you are not asking for? ☐ 90–110 words?

Part 6: An Email to the Letting Agent (90–110 words)

1 two facts with times	Your email arrived to say somebody took it.
2 while or when at least	I was showing the flat on Saturday afternoon.
3 one clear request	When a viewing is booked, please telephone.

Figure 1.27 • The shape of the complaint, step by step.

Write to the person who sent you a message that reached you too late to be any use. Say what you were doing when it arrived, and what you want to happen differently.

Model — read this first:

Dear Ms Dalby, I was showing the first-floor flat to a viewer on Saturday afternoon. Your email arrived to say that somebody took it that morning. My phone was in my coat in the hall and I was talking in the kitchen, so I read it at about half past three. The viewer was already in the building, and stayed another twenty minutes. I am not suggesting you made a mistake, because you sent the email in good time. I am asking for one thing: when a viewing is already booked, please telephone as well. An email is not a cancellation until somebody has read it. (110 words)

Word bank: agent | viewing | email | cancel

Check before you finish: ☐ two facts with times on them? ☐ *while* or *when* at least once? ☐ one clear request at the end? ☐ 90–110 words?

Part 6: What Happened on the Way to the Shift (90–110 words)

1 a beginning and a middle I was on the forty-two, twenty minutes out.

2 what you lost I was reading the handover notes on it.

3 how it finished Two other nurses took the shift before lunch.

Figure 1.28 · The moves of the account, with a line of the model for each.

Tell the story of a journey that stopped being possible halfway through. Use the past continuous for the background and the past simple for what happened.

Model — read this first:

I was on the forty-two and about twenty minutes from the hospital when my phone went flat. I was reading the handover notes on it, so I lost those as well as the number I needed. A woman two seats forward lent me hers straight away, and that was the moment I discovered that I know nobody's number by heart. In the end I rang my mother in another country and she rang the switchboard for me. Two other nurses took the shift before lunch, and I crossed the whole city to find out something a charged phone tells you in four seconds. (105 words)

Plan (fill in, then write): I was ____ when _____. What I lost was _____. The person who helped was _____. What I found out in the end was _____.

Check before you finish: ☐ a beginning, a middle and an end? ☐ how long it took? ☐ both past tenses? ☐ 90–110 words?

Part 6: Reflection — The Afternoon I Lost (80–100 words)

1 what you planned

I had four hours and a short list of three things.

2 what took the time

A delivery slot I did not choose ran until three.

Figure 1.29 • The reflection, step by step.

Write about an afternoon you lost to other people's arrangements. Say what you planned, what actually took the time, and whether you mind.

Model — read this first:

I had four hours on Saturday and a short list of three things. I did none of the three, and I am still not sure where the time went. A delivery slot I did not choose ran from one until three. I spent most of it standing on the pavement where I could see the van. Then a call I agreed to dropped twice, about something that could have waited until Monday. I was annoyed about it for the best part of a day. What I have decided since is that the list was never four hours long. It was a way of pretending that an afternoon belongs to the person living it. (94 words)

Check before you finish: ☐ honestly what took the time? ☐ one sentence about what you decided afterwards? ☐ 80–100 words? **Part 7 • Real-World File — Sorting Out a Delivery to the Wrong Address**

[PLUS] Plus track (optional) • stronger learners

7A: Phrase Bank

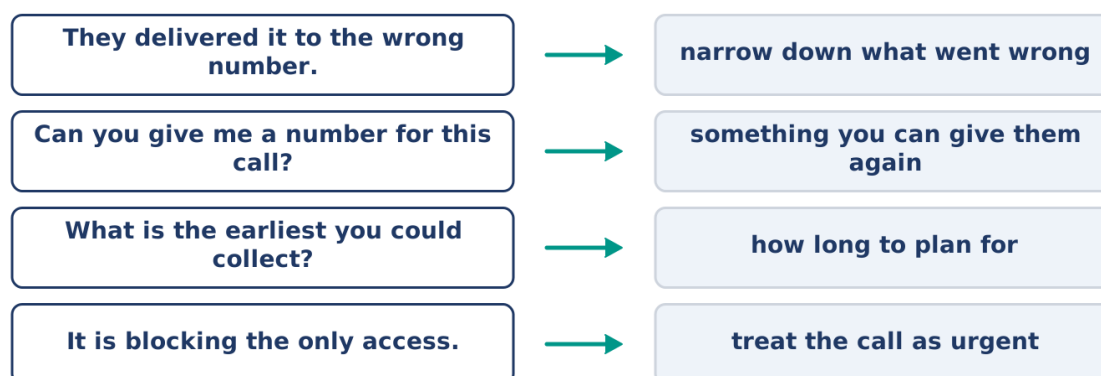


Figure 1.30 • What you say when you report a delivery gone wrong, and what each line does.

Match each phrase with when you would use it. One use is not needed. Write the letter.

Column A

1.	"They delivered it to the wrong number, not the wrong street."	_____
2.	"Can you give me a number for this call?"	_____
3.	"What is the earliest you could collect the skip?"	_____
4.	"It is blocking the only access for a business."	_____
5.	"I am calling for the whole building, not just my own flat."	_____

Column B

a)	when you want the call treated as urgent
b)	when you want to know how much the collection will cost
c)	when you want something you can give them if you have to call again
d)	when you are explaining why you, and not each neighbour, are calling
e)	when you are narrowing down what has actually gone wrong
f)	when you want to know how long to plan for

7B: The Call to the Skip Company

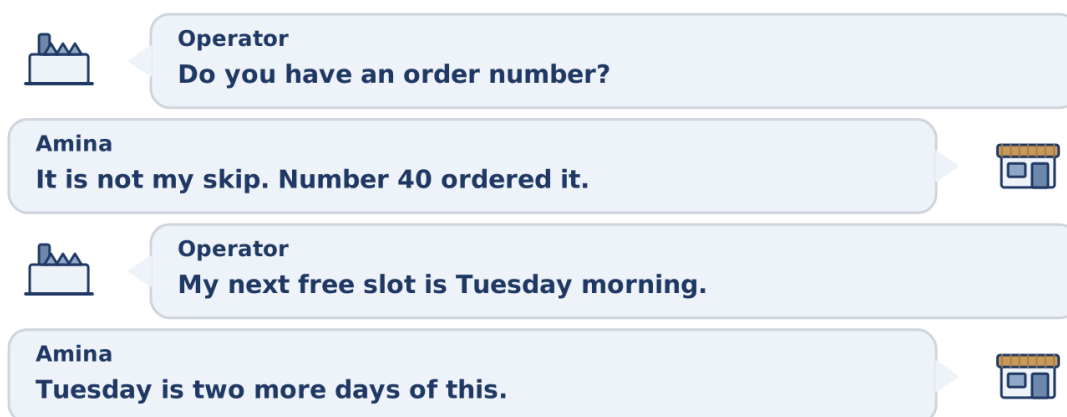


Figure 1.31 · The 7B exchange: who takes each turn.

Audio Track 1.5

Before you read: Amina is ringing the skip company while the skip is still on the pavement. Think about what the person on the other end needs to know first.

OPERATOR: Hadwin Hire, good afternoon. Do you have an order number?

AMINA: I do not, because it is not my skip. They delivered it to the wrong number, not the wrong street. I am at 14 Alder Street and number 40 ordered it.

OPERATOR: Right. I was looking at that road this morning, as it happens. Let me find the booking.

AMINA: It is blocking the only access for a business. My stock van reached the corner at twenty to two and went back to the depot with the whole load.

OPERATOR: I can see it. The driver logged it at 13.32 and the address on the sheet is 14. Somebody has written the wrong number down, and I am sorry about that.

AMINA: What is the earliest you could collect it?

OPERATOR: That is where it gets difficult. It is full already, so it needs the lorry rather than the pickup, and my next free slot is Tuesday morning.

AMINA: Tuesday is two more days of this.

OPERATOR: It is, and I will put you at the top of Tuesday. Can you give me a note of who filled it? If it was number 40, the charge goes to them and not to you. And take a number for this call: yours is 4471.

Answer the questions. (0. is done for you.)

0. What did the operator ask for first? — **An order number.**
1. Why can the skip not be collected with the pickup?
2. What happened to Amina's stock van?
3. Why does the operator want to know who filled the skip?

7C: Controlled Practice — Saying What Went Wrong

☐		Ask what the earliest date is.
☐		Say which part of it is wrong.
☐		Ask for a job number and write it down.
☐		Say why it cannot simply wait.

Figure 1.32 · The steps still to be numbered, as the task prints them.

Put the steps in order. Number them 1-5. (0. is done for you.)

0. Find out what you can before you ring: when the skip arrived, and who ordered it. — 1

____ Ask what the earliest date is, and then ask what would make it sooner.

____ Say which part of it is wrong: the street, the number or the day.

____ Ask for a job number and write it down.

____ Say why it cannot simply wait, in one sentence.

7D: Role-Play — Two Versions of the Same Afternoon

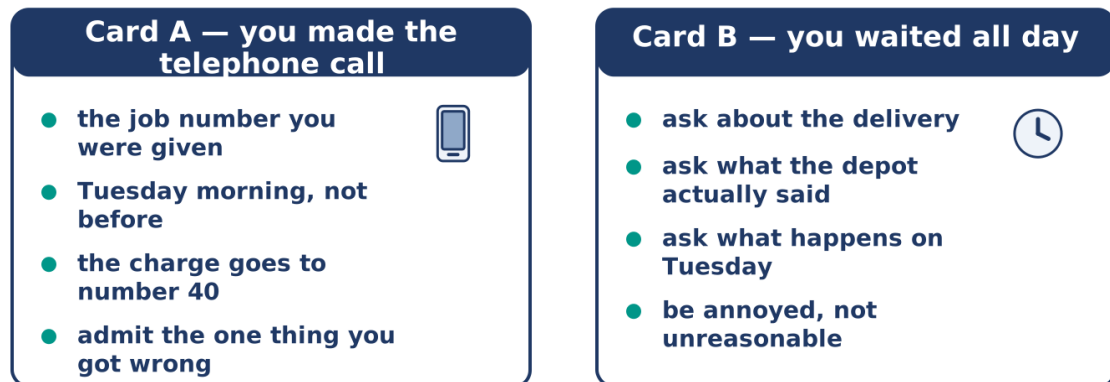


Figure 1.33 • The 7D cards: what each of you has to say.

Model exchange:

AMINA: I have just come off the phone. My number is on their sheet, so the driver made no mistake.

MR OKONKWO: And the pavement?

AMINA: Tuesday morning, because it was full by three and it needs the lorry. I was watching them fill it and I said nothing. I regret that now.

MR OKONKWO: So we lost a delivery and gained a skip.

AMINA: We did. I have a job number, and the charge goes to number 40. That is something.

Student A has made the call and has the job number, the collection date and the news about who pays. **Student B** was waiting for the delivery and wants a straight answer. Take a role each. Student A must pass on three things accurately and admit the one thing they got wrong. Student B must ask at least two questions, and may be annoyed without being unreasonable.

Stretch [PLUS]: swap roles and do it again, with Student B as somebody from number 40 who believes they gave the right address.

7E: Writing — A Note for the Noticeboard (100–120 words)

1	a first line in three seconds	A skip arrived on the pavement outside.
2	what is still unknown	Nobody will say who filled it.
3	what you will do next	I will ring again and give them that number.

Figure 1.34 · The Part 7 note, with the model beside each line.

Write a note for a noticeboard in your building about something you have found out on everybody's behalf — a delivery, a repair, a closure, a change to the bins. Say what they told you, what they did not tell you, and what you will do next.

Model — read this first:

Saturday, about 1.30pm — a skip arrived on the pavement outside our door. It is not ours: number 40 ordered it, and somebody wrote our number on the driver's sheet by mistake. I rang Hadwin Hire at four, while two of you were still putting things into it. They cannot collect before Tuesday morning, because it filled up by three and a full skip needs the lorry. Nobody will say who filled it, and that matters: the charge goes to whoever did. My job number is 4471. If it is still there on Tuesday afternoon, I will ring again and give them that number. Amina, the shop. (112 words)

Check before you finish: ☐ a first line a passer-by understands in three seconds? ☐ what is still unknown? ☐ what you will do next? ☐ 100–120 words? **Part 8 • Global Story — The Day Our Street Became a Film Set**

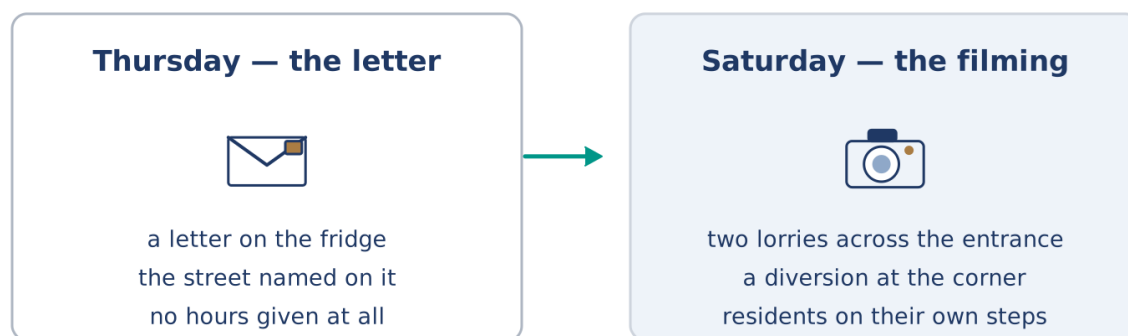


Figure 1.35 • The street at eight in the morning, and the same street at noon.

[PLUS] Plus track • pre-read / discuss

Before you read: a film company closes a residential street for a day. Think about which of your own arrangements would survive that, and which would not.

Gloss: *location* — a real place used for filming instead of a studio • *permit* — written permission from an authority to do something • *diversion* — a route that traffic is sent along when a road is closed • *compensation* — money paid to somebody for trouble or loss they did not cause

The letter came on the Thursday evening, and most people on Calle Sarmiento in Rosario, Argentina, read it some time on Friday. It said that the city had chosen the street as a location, and that the permit covered the Saturday. It ended by asking residents for their understanding. It named the street and it named the day. It did not name the hours, and that is the whole of what went wrong.

Julia Benítez was putting the letter on the fridge when her sister rang about the Saturday. Julia expected no trouble at all, because the word *location* made her think of one camera. She read the word *location* and pictured one camera at the end of the road. At six the next morning two lorries were parking across the entrance. A young man with a list was explaining, very politely, that nobody could drive in or out until the evening.

What a diversion does to a street is not the same for everybody on it. The people who planned nothing had a remarkable day. They sat on their steps and watched the same scene eleven times, and a production company with orders to keep everybody friendly brought them coffee. The people who planned something had a different day. A man two doors up was starting a night shift and could not get his car out at five. A woman on the corner had a hospital appointment at eleven in a district forty minutes away.

The production company thought about this, in the way companies do. There was a telephone number on the letter, and somebody did answer it. The young man with the list walked the woman to a taxi at the far end, and she reached the clinic on time. The production company offered the man on the night shift compensation for a taxi, and he took it. He still says the money was never the point of it. He had to ask a stranger for permission to leave his own street.

By Monday the lorries were gone and the street looked exactly as it always did. Several residents wrote to the city about the permit, and none of them asked for the filming to be stopped. What they asked for was a line on the letter saying when. The city changed the form eight months later, and the new one has three boxes on it: the street, the date and the hours. Julia keeps the old letter on the fridge, underneath the new one.

Answer the questions. (0. is done for you.)

0. What did the letter fail to say? — **The hours the closure would cover.**
1. Why did Julia think the closure would not affect her?
2. What two things did the production company do for people who had arrangements?
3. What change did the residents actually ask the city for?

Part 8: Vocabulary in Context



Figure 1.36 · The five words from the global story, drawn.

Match each word from the story with its meaning. One meaning is not needed. Write the letter.

Column A

1.	Location	_____
2.	Permit	_____
3.	Diversion	_____
4.	Compensation	_____
5.	Resident	_____

Column B

a)	money paid to somebody for trouble they did not cause
b)	written permission from an authority to do something
c)	a real place used for filming instead of a studio

d)	somebody who lives in a particular street or building
e)	the route traffic is sent along when a road is shut
f)	the person who decides where a film is made

Part 8: Discussion

Discussion frames: *What I noticed about this story is...* • *The part I would find hardest is...* • *In my experience, people...*

Talk in groups of three. The man on Calle Sarmiento who was starting a night shift took the compensation, and still says it was not the point. What was the point, and would your street agree with him? Part 9 • Close to Home — Three Weeks Later at Number 14

[PLUS] Plus track • pre-read / decide

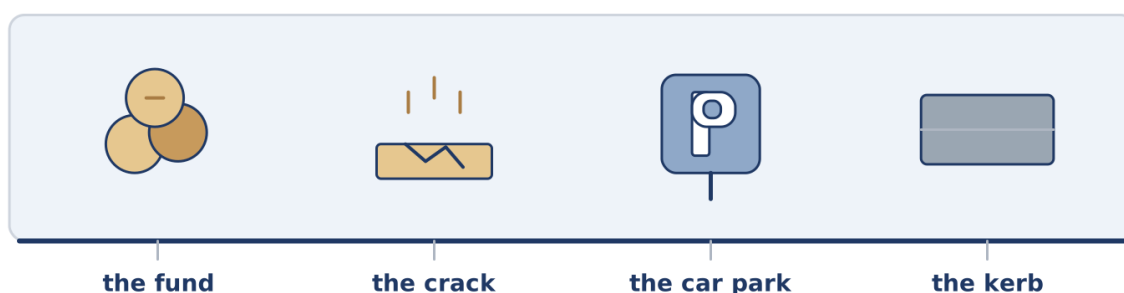


Figure 1.37 • The close-to-home reading, drawn along one street.

Before you read: one cracked window, two hundred and ten pounds, and six people who were all somewhere else.

The residents' meeting at 14 Alder Street ran for an hour and a half. About fifteen minutes of it were about the window. The building fund holds two hundred and ten pounds, collected two pounds at a time, and the glass on the half landing will cost a hundred and forty. The rules of the building put communal glass on the residents, so there is nobody to send the bill to.

Mr Okonkwo thinks the fund should pay and the matter end there. He was in the car park for three hours that afternoon looking for his cat, and he is the only person who was. His view is that a building which spends an evening arguing about a hundred and forty pounds will spend the next one arguing about eighty.

Dani wants the fund to pay and a note in the car park asking people to play at the far end. He was out there twice and saw nothing, and he says that is the point. A rule that asks for something reasonable beats a rule that tries to catch somebody.

Amina does not want to spend the fund at all. She lost a day's trade to the skip that afternoon. Her view is that the building keeps paying for damage and never for the thing that prevents it. She would rather put the money towards a bollard that keeps the kerb clear.

Yuki missed the afternoon and the first half of the meeting. She asked the one question all five people who were there had missed. She wanted to know whether the crack was there before Saturday. Three people could not swear that it was not.

Answer the questions. (0. is done for you.)

0. What do the rules of the building say about communal glass? — **That the residents pay for it.**
1. Why does Mr Okonkwo want the matter to end quickly?
2. What does Amina want to spend the money on instead?
3. What did Yuki ask, and how did people answer?

Part 9: Decision Task

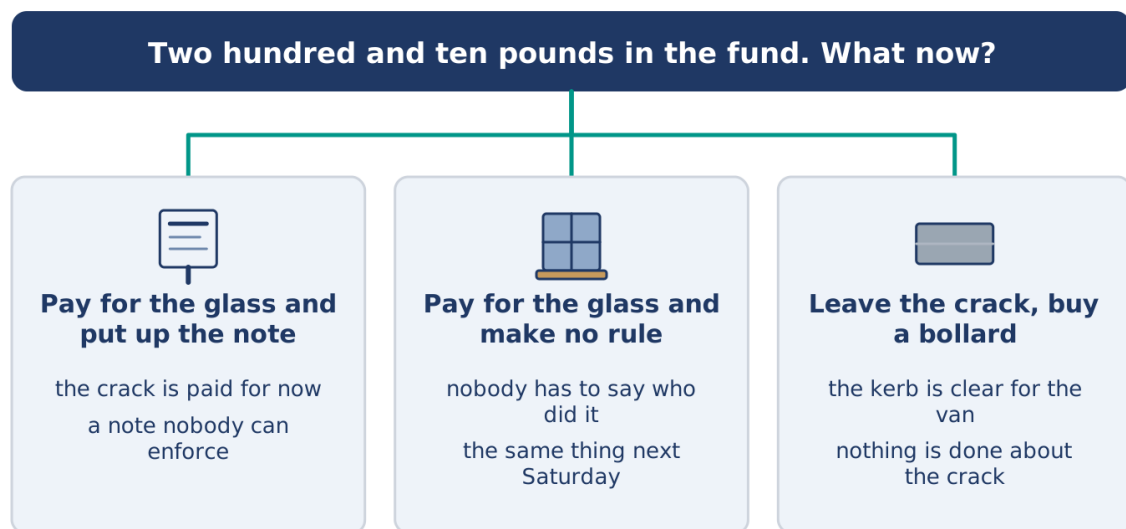


Figure 1.38 · Three ways to decide, and what each one costs.

Model — read this first:

I would pay for the glass out of the fund and put the note up, and that is Dani's answer. Amina is right that the building only ever pays for damage, and she is right that a bollard would save the next day's trade. But the window has a crack in it now and the note costs nothing. Her argument is about the next hundred and forty pounds rather than this one. I would also write down Yuki's question and the answer, because in a year nobody will remember that we were not sure.

Answer frame: I would choose _____, because _____. The strongest argument against it is _____, and my answer to that is _____.

Decide. There are two hundred and ten pounds in the fund. Choose one:

- (a) Pay for the glass and put up the note, leaving seventy pounds.
- (b) Pay for the glass and make no rule at all.
- (c) Leave the crack for now and put the money towards a bollard on the kerb.

Write 60–80 words. Say which you would choose, why, and what you would say to the person who disagrees most. Part 10 • Review and Can-Do

[CORE + PLUS] • homework / self-study

Part 10: Spiral Review



Figure 1.39 • The eight words of the review bank, in bank order.

Complete the sentences using the words in the word bank. (0. is done for you.)

Word bank: landing | depot | queue | was crossing | car park | pavement | while | delivery

0. Maya was serving a **queue** of eleven people when the card reader stopped.
1. The skip was left on the _____ outside number 14, four doors from the house that ordered it.
2. Amina's _____ went back with the whole load, because the van could not get past.
3. Tomas _____ town to cover a shift when the battery in his phone went flat.
4. A crack appeared in the window on the half _____ some time between three and four.
5. _____ Dani was showing the flat, the agent was emailing to say that another viewer took it.
6. Two groups of children were in the _____ behind the building that afternoon.
7. The driver rang the _____ and took the whole load back to it.

Part 10: Can-Do

- ☐ I can say what I was doing when something interrupted me
- ☐ I can use *while* and *when* to join a long action and a short one
- ☐ I can describe a street problem and say what I want agreed
- ☐ I can telephone about a delivery and ask for a job number
- ☐ I can tell the story of an afternoon when several things went wrong **PLUS**

Figure 1.40 · What you can do at the end of this unit.

Can-Do checklist

- ☐ I can say what I was doing when something interrupted me, using the past continuous.
- ☐ I can use *while* and *when* to join a long action and a short one.
- ☐ I can describe a street problem — a skip, a cracked window — and say what I want agreed.
- ☐ I can telephone about a delivery or a booking and ask for a job number.
- ☐ I can tell the story of an afternoon when several things went wrong at once. (Plus)

Part 10: Glossary



Figure 1.41 · All ten glossary words of Unit 1, one card each.

Unit 1 glossary (10 words)

skip · delivery · queue · pavement · card reader · depot · agent · stairwell · crack · slot